

2750 BCE

c.2700 BCE

Egyptians build wooden ships capable of sea voyages. They begin trading with nearby countries.

334 BCE

Alexander the Great invades the Persian Empire, then continues east and north as far as modern-day Pakistan and India.

1001 CE

Viking Leif Ericsson reaches North America and makes a settlement in Newfoundland, Canada.

1488

Bartholomeu Dias of Portugal sails from the Iberian Peninsula to southern Africa.

1497

Vasco da Gama sails around the Cape of Good Hope to India.

1519–21

Portuguese Ferdinand Magellan is the first European to sail from the Atlantic Ocean to the Pacific Ocean.



Portuguese caravel (sailing ship)

1769

Captain James Cook discovers New Zealand.



Statue of Captain James Cook

1943

Jacques Cousteau invents the aqualung, an automatic air supply for divers.

1961

Yuri Gagarin becomes the first man in space.

2012

James Cameron reaches the bottom of the Mariana Trench, the deepest undersea location in the world.

2015

ADVENTURERS AND EXPLORERS

From the first sailing expeditions to rocket-propelled space travel, humans have always gone beyond the limits of their known world to see what else is out there.

1500–500 BCE

Phoenicians (from modern-day Israel and Lebanon) explore the Mediterranean, then as far as west Africa and Britain, looking for new trading partners.



Phoenician traders

1271

Marco Polo begins his exploration of China and Asia.



Marco Polo's China and Asia expedition

1492

Christopher Columbus lands in America and claims it for Spain.



Christopher Columbus's coat of arms

1577–80

Englishman Sir Francis Drake circumnavigates the globe (sails round the world).



Statue of Sir Francis Drake

1642

Abel Tasman explores Van Diemen's Land (now Tasmania).



Deep-sea diving helmet

1819

Augustus Siebe invents a helmet that enables divers to work at a depth of 60 m (196.8 ft).



Arctic explorer's sealskin hood and gloves

1858

John Hanning Speke discovers Lake Victoria, Africa.

1911

Norwegian Roald Amundsen and his team reach the South Pole.



Amundsen arriving at the South Pole

1969

Neil Armstrong, commander of USA's Apollo 11 mission, sets foot on the moon.



Apollo 11 commemoration badge

Exploration

The first explorers set sail in search of new places to buy and sell goods. Later, people led expeditions to get rich, to claim territory for their country or religion, to make scientific discoveries, or simply for the thrill of adventure.

EXPLORERS OF THE ANCIENT WORLD

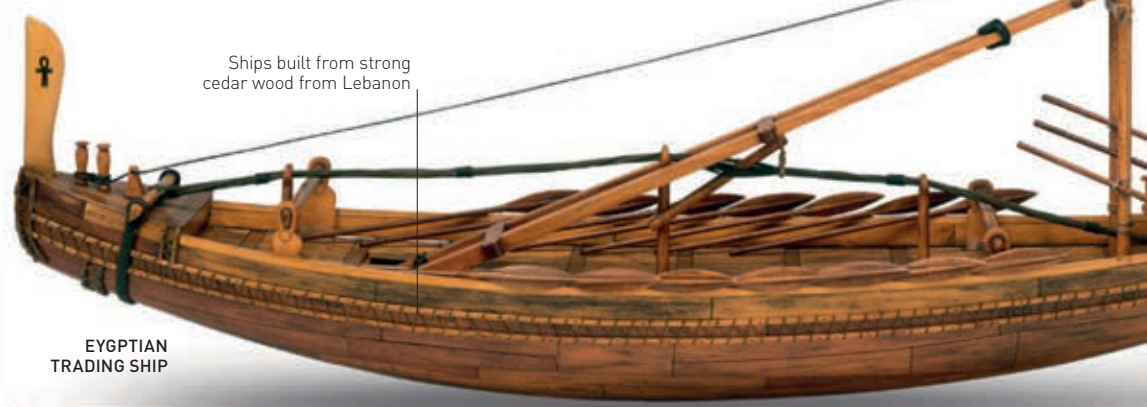
The earliest explorers were the Phoenicians and the Egyptians, who wanted to find markets to trade their goods. Later cultures, such as the Romans and Vikings, also wanted to conquer new territories to expand their empires.



PHOENICIAN TRADING SHIP



VIKING LONGSHIP



EGYPTIAN TRADING SHIP

THE AGE OF EXPLORATION

In the early 15th century, Portuguese sailors set out to find a sea route to Asia. This triggered a wave of exploration, as rival countries found new trading routes and established colonies all over the world.

KEY

- Magellan's route
- Other Spanish missions
- Portuguese expeditions
- English expeditions
- French expeditions
- Dutch expeditions



SOME EXPEDITIONS TOOK MANY YEARS, AS THE SHIPS COULD ONLY COVER ABOUT 160 KM (100 MILES) IN A DAY